

Session 22: Covenant Ratified

Key Takeaways

- Ratifying the covenant, or making it an active reality, is a solemn ritual.
- The people of Israel enter into the covenant with Yahweh voluntarily and eagerly.
- The blood of the covenant marks people as members of the covenant community.

Covenant Ratification Ritual

Exodus 24:1-11 outlines the covenant ratification ritual. This list highlights key features of the ritual.

- Context of worship (v. 1-2, 9-11)
- Clear articulation of expectations (v. 3, 7)
- Verbal agreement from the people (v. 3, 7)
- Written record of expectations (v. 4)
- Stone pillars to represent all 12 tribes (v. 4)
- Ritual offerings (v. 4-5)
- Blood symbolism (v. 6, 8)

What Does the Sprinkled Blood Symbolize?

The priestly ordination ritual also applies blood to both altar and person (Lev. 8:23-24, 30). The sprinkling of blood marks the official entrance into the covenant and underscores Israel's role as a kingdom of priests.

Note: Leviticus 14:1-32 reinstates an unclean person to the covenant community with sprinkled blood, but that blood is not applied to the altar.

Recommended Resources

- Dr. Sandra L. Richter. [*"Does God Really Command Women to Marry Their Rapists? A Study of Deuteronomic Law."*](#) HebraicThought.org.
- Celina Durgin and Dru Johnson (editors). [*The Biblical World of Gender: The Daily Lives of Ancient Men and Women.*](#)

Reflection Question

Are there other laws from Exodus 20-24 that you still have questions about?